

GATEWAY Program

The Professional Sustainability & Growth Plan

1. Portfolio Task: The "Professional Sustainability & Growth Plan"

A. The Reputation Defense (Lesson 6.1):

- **The Mock Review Response:** Imagine you received a 3-star review saying: *"The quality was okay, but they missed the deadline by two hours and didn't apologize."* * **Task:** Write your professional public reply here:

e.g. The Mock Review Response: "Thank you for your honest feedback. I sincerely apologize for the two-hour delay and for not communicating this sooner. I have since updated my delivery schedule to ensure every project is submitted early, and I'd value the chance to show you this improved process on a future project".

Thank you for your candid feedback and for recognizing the quality of the designs. I sincerely apologize for the two-hour delay in delivering your final Figma files and for not notifying you earlier. I have updated my design delivery workflows and buffer times to ensure every project is submitted ahead of schedule. I would welcome the opportunity to work together again and demonstrate this improved process on your next design project.

- **The Soft Pivot Template:** Create a customized "Soft Pivot" script for your specific niche to handle a client asking for a "small favor" that is actually extra work.

e.g. The Soft Pivot Template: "I would be happy to handle those extra revisions for you! Since this falls outside our original project scope, it will require an additional fee of \$20. Should I send over an updated contract for us to get started?"

I would be glad to design those additional user screens and interactive prototype flows for you! Since adding these extra screens falls outside our original project scope, it will require an additional fee of \$50. Should I prepare an updated proposal and contract for us to get started?

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B. The Income Pipe (Lesson 6.2):

- **The Retainer Pitch:** Identify one service in your niche that could be turned into a monthly recurring task.

Identify the Service: [e.g., Monthly Social Media Management]

e.g. Identify the Service: Monthly Social Media Management (including 10 graphics and 5 captions).

Identify the Service:

Monthly Design System Maintenance & UI Kit Asset Updates (including adding new reusable components, icon sets, and maintaining accessibility tokens).

Write your "Discovery Question" to lead into the pitch

e.g. The Discovery Question: "Now that we've successfully launched your new brand logo, who will be managing your weekly social media designs to keep your engagement high?"

The Discovery Question: "Now that your app is live, who's going to handle small updates, design tweaks, and fixes as users start giving feedback?"

Write your 2-sentence "Peace of Mind" Retainer Pitch).

e.g. The Retainer Pitch: "I can manage your full monthly social media design schedule for a flat recurring fee. This gives you peace of mind knowing your brand stays consistent while you focus on closing sales".

The Retainer Pitch: "I can manage all ongoing design and front-end updates for a flat monthly fee. That way, your app stays updated while you focus on growing the business."

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C. The Professional Shield (Lesson 6.3):

- **The Security Audit:** List 3 specific actions you will take to protect your client's data (Data Privacy) and avoid scams.

Action 1: [e.g., Using password-protected folders for client assets]

e.g. Action 1: I will use password-protected folders (like Google Drive or OneDrive) to ensure all sensitive client assets are stored securely.

Action 1:

I will use password-protected design files and cloud storage (such as Figma permissions or Google Drive) to ensure all sensitive client brand assets, user data, and wireframes are stored securely.

Action 2: [e.g., Never taking payments via gift cards or off-platform]

e.g. Action 2: I will never take payments off-platform or via gift cards, ensuring all transactions are protected by the platform's official dispute protocol.

Action 2:

I will never accept payments off-platform, via wire transfers, or through gift cards, ensuring all project milestones and payments are protected by the platform's official escrow and dispute protocol.

Action 3: [e.g., Disclosing AI use to every client before starting]

e.g. Action 3: I will disclose my use of AI tools (like ChatGPT or Midjourney) in the brainstorming phase to maintain 100% transparency and build long-term trust.

Action 3:

I will disclose my use of AI tools (like Midjourney or ChatGPT for copywriting and moodboarding) during the exploratory phase to maintain 100% transparency and build long-term trust.

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